Loyiso Sonti — Personal Portfolio Website

1. Project Description

This project is a personal portfolio website developed by **Loyiso Sonti**, an Information Technology student specialising in Systems Development at Gauteng City College.

The purpose of this website is to introduce me, showcase my technical skills, display examples of my projects, and provide contact information.

The website uses HTML5, CSS3, and JavaScript. It has a modern black, grey, and white design and is responsive, meaning it can adapt to different screen sizes, including computers, tablets, and mobile phones.

This project was created as part of the Web Development module to demonstrate my understanding of website structure, styling, responsiveness, and JavaScript functionality.

2. Project Information

- **Project Name:** Loyiso Sonti Personal Portfolio
- **Developer:** Loyiso Sonti
- **Institution:** Gauteng City College
- **Course:** Information Technology — Systems Development
- **Module:** Web Development
- **Project Type:** Personal Portfolio Website

3. Live Website

GitHub Pages Link: Add your published website link here.

Example format:

https://Loyd-14.github.io/loyiso-portfolio/

4. Technologies Used

HTML5

HTML5 is used to structure the website and organise its content into sections, including Home, About Me, Skills, Projects, and Contact.

CSS3

CSS3 is used to style the website. It provides the black, grey, and white colour scheme, card layouts, spacing, buttons, hover effects, and responsive design.

JavaScript

JavaScript adds interactive features to the website, including:

- Mobile navigation menu.
- Dark and light mode switch.
- Contact form validation.
- Automatic copyright year.

No external JavaScript libraries or CSS frameworks are required for the current version.

5. Website Features

Home Section

Introduces me as a Systems Development student and aspiring software developer. It includes buttons that allow visitors to navigate to my projects and contact information.

About Me Section

Provides information about my studies, interests in technology, and career goals.

Skills Section

Displays technical areas I am learning, including:

- HTML5
- CSS3
- JavaScript
- Java
- Databases
- IT Fundamentals

Projects Section

Displays example projects that demonstrate areas of interest and learning:

- Personal Portfolio Website
- Calculator Application
- Student Database System

The project descriptions should be updated to accurately represent my actual work and indicate which projects are still proposed or under development.

Contact Section

Displays my contact details:

- **Name:** Loyiso Sonti
- **Cellphone:** 076 894 6840
- **Email:** loyisosonti14@gmail.com

The email address opens the visitor's default email application, while the cellphone link can open a compatible calling application.

Responsive Design

The website uses CSS media queries to adjust its layout for different screen sizes.

Dark and Light Mode

Visitors can switch between dark and light themes. JavaScript uses browser storage to remember the selected theme when supported.

Contact Form Validation

JavaScript checks whether the visitor has entered a valid name, email address, and message.

Important: The current form only validates the information entered. It does not send emails or store messages.

Automatic Copyright Year

JavaScript automatically displays the current year in the footer.

6. Project Folder Structure

The project contains three main files:

loyiso-portfolio/

│

├── index.html

├── style.css

├── script.js

└── README.md

- index.html — Contains the website's structure and content.
- style.css — Contains the website's design, colours, layouts, and responsive styling.
- script.js — Controls interactive features and form validation.
- README.md — Provides information about the project, technologies, features, references, and setup instructions.

7. How to Run the Project Locally

Follow these steps to run the website on your computer:

1. Download or clone the project repository from GitHub.
2. Open the project folder in Visual Studio Code or another code editor.
3. Confirm that index.html, style.css, and script.js are in the same folder.
4. Open index.html in a web browser.
5. Test the navigation menu, theme switch, responsive layout, and contact form validation.

Clone the Repository

After creating your GitHub repository, run the following command in your terminal, replacing the example address with your repository's actual URL:

git clone YOUR-REPOSITORY-URL

Open the downloaded project folder and launch index.html in your browser.

8. Deployment

The website is intended to be hosted using GitHub Pages.

To publish the website:

1. Create a public GitHub repository.
2. Upload index.html, style.css, script.js, and README.md.
3. Open the repository's **Settings**.
4. Select **Pages**.
5. Choose the branch containing your website files, usually main.
6. Select the root folder if your files are stored in the repository's main directory.
7. Save the settings and wait for GitHub Pages to publish the website.
8. Open the generated website link and test that all sections and features work correctly.

The live website link should be added to Section 3 after successful deployment.

9. References and Acknowledgements

AI Assistance

Tool: ChatGPT by OpenAI.

Purpose: ChatGPT was used to assist with developing and correcting the HTML structure, CSS styling, JavaScript functionality, website layout, and README documentation.

The generated code was adapted for a personal portfolio website with a black, grey, and white colour scheme.

External Resources

The following official documentation can be consulted when developing and publishing the project:

- **GitHub Pages Documentation:** https://docs.github.com/en/pages
- **MDN Web Docs — HTML:** https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/HTML
- **MDN Web Docs — CSS:** https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/CSS
- **MDN Web Docs — JavaScript:** https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/JavaScript

10. Future Improvements

Possible future improvements include:

- Adding links to completed projects.
- Including a professional profile photograph.
- Adding a downloadable CV.
- Connecting the contact form to a service that can deliver messages.
- Adding project filtering or further animations.
- Improving accessibility and testing the website across different browsers.

11. Conclusion

This portfolio website demonstrates my developing knowledge of HTML5, CSS3, and JavaScript. It provides an introduction to my background, skills, and projects while allowing visitors to contact me.

The project also gives me practical experience in responsive web design, interactive functionality, documentation, and website deployment using GitHub Pages.